

ITEM WISE EDITORIALS

15th WEEK



**ONCE AGAIN NETANYAHU ! ...
PALESTINE ISSUE MAY BECOME
COMPLEX !**



Learning Space



NEWSPAPER EDITORIALS ... DISCUSSION

12th APRIL, 2019

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Netanyahu's Israel

As he tries to clinch a fifth term as PM, hopes for peace in Palestine dim further

The April 9 parliamentary elections in Israel have underscored the structural shift in the country's democracy – the right wing reigns supreme. Prime Minister Benjamin Netanyahu had faced serious challenges during the campaign. He faces corruption allegations that could lead to his indictment. The Blue and White party, formed a few weeks ahead of the election, had quickly risen to become the principal opposition force, giving Mr. Netanyahu a scare. He had lost some allies even before the elections. In the event, Mr. Netanyahu has emerged victorious. While both Mr. Netanyahu's Likud party and the Blue and White got 25 seats each (after 98% of the votes were counted), he could become Prime Minister for a fifth time with support from rightwing parties. Likud has markedly improved its performance from 2015, when it had won 30 seats and still formed the government. The orthodox Jewish parties Shas and United Torah Judaism, which won seven and six seats respectively in 2015, secured eight each this time. The Union of Rightwing Parties and the right-nationalist Yisrael Beytenu have won five seats each, while the centrist Kadima has got four. With the support of these potential allies, Mr. Netanyahu would have the backing of 65 MPs, well past the halfway mark in the 120-member Knesset.

Mr. Netanyahu ran a contentious, ultra-nationalist campaign to drum up support for Likud and its allies. He had publicly aligned with Jewish Power, a fringe party known for its racist, anti-Arab views. If Mr. Netanyahu had said there wouldn't be any Palestinian state under his watch during the 2015 election campaign, this time, a few days ahead of the poll, he said he would annex parts of the West Bank to bring Jewish settlements under Israeli sovereignty. He also exploited the security concerns of Israeli voters by presenting himself as the only leader capable of keeping them safe from "Palestinian terrorists" as well as Iran. Mr. Netanyahu is credited with stabilising the Israeli economy and, more controversially, clinching major diplomatic coups such as the U.S. recognition of Jerusalem as Israel's capital and the occupied Syrian Golan as Israeli territory, thanks to American President Donald Trump. Mr. Netanyahu is now set to become the longest-serving Prime Minister, overtaking David Ben-Gurion, the country's founder. But the Israel he leads today is totally different from what even Ben-Gurion and the early socialist Zionists had imagined. With Mr. Netanyahu showing no interest in the peace process and the occupation of Palestine being deepened both militarily and through Jewish settlements in the West Bank, Israel, which is described by a Basic Law passed last year as "the nation state of the Jewish people", is a *de facto* apartheid state. Given his record, there is little reason to hope that Mr. Netanyahu will break the status quo during his next term.

UPSC CSE – GS II

GS II ... International Relations

Effect of policies and politics of developed and developing countries on India's interests, Indian diaspora.

1 Netanyahu's Israel

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Mr. Netanyahu ran a contentious, ultra-nationalist campaign to drum up support for Likud and its allies. He had publicly aligned with Jewish Power, a fringe party known for its racist, anti-Arab views. If Mr. Netanyahu had said there wouldn't be any Palestinian state under his watch during the 2015 election campaign, this time, a few days ahead of the poll, he said he would annex parts of the West Bank to bring Jewish settlements under Israeli sovereignty. He also exploited the security concerns of Israeli voters by presenting himself as the only leader capable of keeping them safe from "Palestinian terrorists" as well as Iran. Mr. Netanyahu is credited with stabilising the Israeli economy and, more controversially, clinching major diplomatic coups such as the U.S. recognition of Jerusalem as Israel's capital and the occupied Syrian Golan as Israeli territory, thanks to American President Donald Trump. Mr. Netanyahu is now set to become the longest-serving Prime Minister, overtaking David Ben-Gurion, the country's founder. But the Israel he leads today is totally different from what even Ben-Gurion and the early socialist Zionists had imagined. With Mr. Netanyahu showing no interest in the peace process and the occupation of Palestine being deepened both militarily and through Jewish settlements in the West Bank, Israel, which is described by a Basic Law passed last year as "the nation state of the Jewish people", is a de facto apartheid state. Given his record, there is little reason to hope that Mr. Netanyahu will break the status quo during his next term.



Cyprus

Mediterranean Sea

ISRAEL

SYRIA

LEBANON

Sea of Galilee

IRAQ

Jordan River

Dead Sea

JORDAN

EGYPT

Gulf of Aqaba

SAUDI ARABIA

Learning Space

- Prime Minister Benjamin Netanyahu has won the Israeli National Election.
- He secured a record 5th term in Office.
- Mr. Netanyahu is in a strong position to form a coalition Government with other right-wing factions that have backed him.
- 65 out of Knesset's 120 would go to the right-wing block of parties led by Mr. Netanyahu.
- If he wins, Mr. Netanyahu 69, will be on track to be the longest serving Prime Minister in Israel's 71-year history.





Occupied Heights

The Golan Heights, which the United States declared as Israeli territory on Monday, has been occupied by Israel since it captured the area from Syria in 1967

1967 Syrian forces fire on Israel from the Golan Heights during the 1967 war, prompting the Israeli Army to enter and seize 1,200 sq. km of area

1967-73 More than 1,50,000 people, mostly Syrians, flee the area

1973 Israel occupies a further 510 sq. km during the 1973 West Asia war but returns the territory a year later

1974 'Separation of Forces' agreement creates a 'Line A', behind which Israeli forces should remain, and a 'Line B', behind which Syrian forces should remain

1981 Israel passes a law formally annexing the occupied area

2011 Tensions flare with the start of the Syrian uprising

2014 Islamists overrun Quneitra, near the Golan Heights

2018 Syrian forces retake control over Quneitra and surrounding areas following a Russia-backed offensive



Who lives there?

- Around 18,000 Syrians from the Druze sect - most of whom refuse to take Israeli citizenship
- Around 20,000 Israeli settlers

- Three tributaries - the Banias, the Dan and the Hasbani - cross the highlands

- The river system provides about 40% of Israel's water

Strategic importance

- The fertile volcanic plateau is key to the region's water supply

- A 400 sq.-km 'Area of Separation' separates the Israeli and Syrian sides

Nobody could have believed that a man would come in America and unilaterally and against all international laws and regulations give away a land belonging to one country to an aggressor - **HASSAN ROUHANI**, Iran President



HOW TO VIEW THIS?



- 1 He publicly aligned with Jewish Power, a Fringe Party known for its racist, anti-Arab views.

- 2 In 2015 election campaign, Mr. Netanyahu said, there won't be any Palestinian State under his watch.
- 3 This time he said, he would annex parts of West bank to bring Jewish settlements under Israeli sovereignty.
- 4 He also exploited security concerns by projecting himself as the only leader capable of keeping safe from Palestinian Terrorists as well as Iran.
- 5 Already, he got major diplomatic coups, such as the US recognition of Jerusalem as Israel's capital and occupied Syrian Golan as Israeli territory.

SOLUTION TO PALESTINIAN ISSUE MAY BECOME QUITE COMPLEX!



BENJAMIN NETANYAHU
PRIME MINISTER OF
ISRAEL



DAVID BEN-GURION
FORMER PRIME
MINISTER OF ISRAEL

He is going to become the longest-serving Prime Minister, overtaking David Ben-Gurion, the Country's founder.

- 1** Israel is totally different from, what even Ben-Gurion imagined. Mr. Netanyahu is no interest in the peace process.
- 2** Occupation of Palestine deepened, both militarily and through Jewish settlements in the West Bank.
- 3** Israel was described by a Basic Law passed last year as "the nation state of the Jewish people".

The solution to Palestine-Israel issue will become highly complex in future!

WE EXPRESS OUR
SINCERE THANKS
FOR VIEWING THIS VIDEO

Presented by



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